



Subject Vision and Intent: English

Our Vision

At King's Cross Academy, we believe that language gives children the power to understand the world, communicate with others and express who they are. Our ambition is for every child to leave KCA with a lifelong love of reading, the confidence and skill to write with purpose, and the ability to communicate their ideas clearly and effectively.

We want children to discover the power of words. Through literature, they encounter new worlds, experiences and perspectives; through writing, they learn to shape and communicate ideas of their own; and through speaking and listening, they develop the confidence to find their voice, articulate their thinking and engage thoughtfully with others.

Our English curriculum reflects our Academy vision, *Love Learning Together*. Reading, writing and communication enable children to learn with and from one another and provide access to learning across the entire curriculum. They also develop our KCA values: the courage to share an idea, the respect to listen to another perspective, the endurance to refine a piece of writing and the aspiration to communicate with increasing confidence, precision and creativity.

Our Intent

Our English curriculum is ambitious, inclusive and carefully sequenced. It identifies the essential knowledge, vocabulary and skills we want children to develop from the Early Years to Year 6, enabling them to become increasingly fluent, thoughtful and independent speakers, readers and writers.

Speaking and Listening

Oracy is central to children's learning at KCA. We deliberately develop children's spoken language so that they learn to articulate ideas, explain their thinking, listen attentively, ask questions and respond thoughtfully to others.

Children encounter and use increasingly rich vocabulary and are taught how spoken language changes according to audience, purpose and context. Through discussion, presentation, performance and debate, children develop the confidence to speak to different audiences while learning that effective communication involves listening as carefully as speaking.

We recognise that spoken language provides an important foundation for reading, writing and learning across the curriculum. Children are therefore given regular opportunities to rehearse ideas aloud, develop vocabulary and use talk to deepen their thinking.

Reading

Reading is at the heart of our curriculum. Our ambition is for every child to learn to read successfully and then to become a child who chooses to read.

From the Early Years, children develop the foundations of reading through language, stories, songs and rhyme before systematic phonics teaching enables them to decode increasingly independently. As decoding becomes secure, children develop the fluency and automaticity that allow them to focus increasingly upon meaning.

Alongside learning how to read, children develop their comprehension through rich discussion of texts. They learn to retrieve information, make inferences, consider vocabulary and language choices, summarise, make connections and increasingly justify interpretations using evidence.

Children encounter a carefully chosen range of high-quality fiction, non-fiction, poetry and other texts. We want the books children encounter to provide both mirrors and windows: opportunities to recognise something of themselves and their experiences while also encountering lives, places, cultures and perspectives beyond their own.

Vocabulary is deliberately developed through reading and across the wider curriculum. Children learn the meanings of increasingly sophisticated words and develop the confidence to use them when speaking and writing.

Writing

We want children to understand that writing is a powerful means of communicating ideas.

Children develop secure foundations in transcription, including handwriting and spelling, alongside progressively sophisticated knowledge of vocabulary, grammar, punctuation and sentence construction. This knowledge enables children to concentrate increasingly upon the meaning and effect of what they want to communicate.

Children write for a range of meaningful purposes, audiences and forms. They learn to draw upon their reading and wider experiences, generate and organise ideas, select vocabulary and grammatical structures deliberately and consider how their choices affect the reader.

Writing is taught as a process. Children learn to plan, compose, reread, evaluate, edit and improve their work. As they progress through the school, they become increasingly independent in making choices about content, structure, vocabulary and style.

We want children to develop their own voices as writers. The knowledge and conventions of written English provide children with the tools they need, but our ambition extends beyond technical accuracy: we want children to use those tools confidently, purposefully and creatively.

Every Child

We have high expectations for every child. Children with SEND, children who are disadvantaged and children who are developing English as an additional language access the same ambitious English curriculum.

Teachers identify the essential knowledge and skills children need and adapt teaching so that barriers are reduced without lowering expectations. Explicit instruction, modelling, carefully chosen texts, structured talk, visual support, repeated practice and opportunities to revisit important learning enable children to develop increasing independence.

We recognise that children's experiences of language, books and reading beyond school can differ considerably. We therefore ensure that every child has access to rich language, high-quality literature and regular opportunities to read, write, discuss and perform.

Where children are at risk of falling behind in reading, difficulties are identified quickly and additional teaching is provided so that they can develop the knowledge and fluency required to access the wider curriculum. Learning to read successfully is an entitlement for every child.

We also recognise the extraordinary linguistic diversity of our community. The languages children speak are valued as an important part of their identities, while we explicitly teach the English vocabulary and language structures they need to participate confidently in learning and communicate successfully.

English Beyond the Curriculum

Our commitment to reading, writing and communication extends beyond English lessons.

Through our whole-school Reading Journey, children are encouraged to encounter a rich range of books throughout their time at KCA. We want reading to become part of children's identities and to develop a culture in which books are discussed, recommended, shared and enjoyed.

Performance and spoken communication are also important parts of children's experience at KCA. Through opportunities including LAMDA, children develop their confidence in speaking, performing and communicating to an audience, applying the spoken-language skills developed through the curriculum in authentic contexts.

Across the wider curriculum, children use reading to acquire knowledge, writing to communicate what they understand and talk to develop and articulate their thinking. We want children to recognise that English is not confined to an English lesson: language provides access to every area of learning.

By the end of Year 6, our aim is not simply that children can read, write and speak accurately. We want them to choose to read, to write with confidence and purpose, and to know that their voice deserves to be heard.

Above all, we want children to leave KCA as confident, thoughtful and enthusiastic readers, writers and communicators who possess the knowledge and command of language they need to learn, create, participate and make sense of the world around them.